

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 14: India and Her Neighbours

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	14 — India and Her Neighbours
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the classic traps: a neighbour need NOT share a land border - Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours; an 'open border' (India-Nepal) still IS a border, just visa-free; Indian culture spread to Thailand and Indonesia PEACEFULLY through trade, travel and religion, not by conquest (so the Ramakien is Thailand's own version of the Ramayana); and landlocked neighbours like Nepal and Bhutan still need the sea, reaching it through Indian ports. Use the pack's figures (land boundary ~15,100 km, coastline ~11,100 km). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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1. A 'neighbour' country, in this chapter, can be one that shares with India:
(A) only a land border
(B) only the same language
(C) only the same currency
(D) either a land border or a sea (a land or a maritime neighbour)
 2. A 'maritime neighbour' is a country:
(A) connected to another by a shared sea or ocean, even without a land border
(B) that shares only a land border
(C) that is completely landlocked
(D) that has no coastline at all
 3. The claim 'a neighbour must share a land border with us' is wrong because:
(A) every neighbour does share a land border
(B) India has no maritime neighbours
(C) the sea cannot connect countries
(D) Sri Lanka and the Maldives are close neighbours linked by sea, not land
 4. Which list contains only LAND neighbours of India?
(A) Sri Lanka, Maldives, Indonesia and Thailand
(B) Pakistan, Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh
(C) Sri Lanka, Nepal, Oman and Iran
(D) Maldives, Bhutan, Singapore and Myanmar

- 5.** Sri Lanka and the Maldives are best described as India's:
- (A) land neighbours (B) landlocked neighbours
(C) maritime neighbours (D) non-neighbours
- 6.** India lies at the heart of:
- (A) the Pacific Ocean and East Asia (B) the Atlantic Ocean and Europe
(C) the Arctic and North America (D) South Asia and the Indian Ocean
- 7.** According to the chapter, India's land boundary is about:
- (A) 1,510 km long (B) 151 km long
(C) 51,000 km long (D) 15,100 km long
- 8.** According to the chapter, India's coastline is about:
- (A) 111 km long (B) 1,110 km long
(C) 11,100 km long (D) 91,000 km long
- 9.** India's long coastline and central position in the Indian Ocean make it:
- (A) cut off from all other countries (B) unable to trade by sea
(C) well placed to connect with many maritime neighbours by sea
(D) a landlocked country
- 10.** 'Regionalism' means neighbouring countries:
- (A) fighting one another for territory (B) ignoring each other entirely
(C) working together for peace, stability and shared progress
(D) merging into one single country
- 11.** The chapter says being neighbours is not just about borders but about:
- (A) working together for the good of the whole region
(B) building the highest walls possible (C) trading only with distant continents
(D) keeping every culture strictly separate
- 12.** Centuries of shared Buddhism, Hinduism, trade and festivals show that India's neighbourhood is:
- (A) knit together by deep cultural and historical ties
(B) completely disconnected (C) linked only by modern aeroplanes
(D) united only by a common king
- 13.** India and China are separated mainly by the:
- (A) Indian Ocean (B) Himalayas
(C) Thar Desert (D) Palk Strait
- 14.** As a land neighbour to the north, China shares with India a:
- (A) maritime border across the Pacific (B) visa-free open border like Nepal's
(C) long Himalayan land border (D) shared island chain

- 15.** The Himalayas acting as a natural boundary between India and China is an example of how:
- (A) borders are always drawn by the sea
 - (B) geography can shape the border between two countries
 - (C) mountains make trade impossible forever
 - (D) geography has no effect on neighbours
- 16.** India and Pakistan are described as neighbours with a:
- (A) shared heritage but a divided history
 - (B) completely unrelated past
 - (C) shared visa-free open border like Nepal's
 - (D) purely maritime link only
- 17.** The phrase 'a shared heritage, a divided history' for India and Pakistan means they:
- (A) have nothing in common at all
 - (B) are actually the same country today
 - (C) share deep cultural roots yet were separated into different nations
 - (D) never had any connection
- 18.** Afghanistan is described as India's:
- (A) nearest maritime neighbour
 - (B) ancient land-linked friend
 - (C) an island archipelago
 - (D) a country with no historical ties to India
- 19.** The 'Uttarapatha' was:
- (A) a southern sea route to Sri Lanka
 - (B) a school of Buddhism
 - (C) a Himalayan mountain peak
 - (D) the ancient northern trade route linking the Ganga plains to Central Asia via Afghanistan
- 20.** That the Uttarapatha ran through Afghanistan shows that, long ago, Afghanistan was:
- (A) an important link on India's overland trade routes
 - (B) completely cut off from India
 - (C) only ever reachable by sea
 - (D) an island in the Indian Ocean
- 21.** Bangladesh is called a 'newborn neighbour' because it:
- (A) is the oldest country in the world
 - (B) has existed since ancient times unchanged
 - (C) is not actually a country
 - (D) became a separate nation relatively recently
- 22.** A 'transboundary river' is one that:
- (A) never crosses any border
 - (B) flows only underground
 - (C) flows across the border of two or more countries
 - (D) flows uphill from the sea
- 23.** Rivers shared by India and Bangladesh are a reason the two countries must:
- (A) never speak to each other
 - (B) build dams to stop all flow
 - (C) cooperate on managing their shared waters
 - (D) pretend the rivers do not exist

24. The India-Nepal border is famous for being:

- (A) completely sealed and impossible to cross
- (B) a maritime border across the ocean
- (C) a high wall with no gates
- (D) an 'open border' that people can cross without a visa or passport

25. The claim 'the open border between India and Nepal means there is no border at all' is wrong because:

- (A) there really is no border
- (B) the border exists; it is just open, and both countries still cooperate to keep it safe
- (C) Nepal is part of India
- (D) the border is a high sealed wall

26. Nepal lies 'in the lap of the Himalayas' and is:

- (A) an island nation in the Indian Ocean
- (B) a landlocked country with no coastline
- (C) a maritime neighbour with a long coast
- (D) a desert country by the sea

27. A 'landlocked' country is one that:

- (A) is made up entirely of islands
- (B) has the world's longest coastline
- (C) lies in the middle of an ocean
- (D) has no coastline and is surrounded entirely by land

28. The belief 'a landlocked country like Nepal has no need for the sea' is wrong because:

- (A) its goods usually travel out through Indian ports, making India its gateway to the sea
- (B) landlocked countries never trade with anyone
- (C) Nepal has its own ocean coast
- (D) the sea is useless for trade

29. Bhutan is known as the:

- (A) 'Nation of Islets'
- (B) 'Golden Land of the South'
- (C) 'Land of the Thunder Dragon'
- (D) 'Gateway to Southeast Asia'

30. 'Gross National Happiness' is Bhutan's way of measuring progress by:

- (A) counting only the money the country earns
- (B) measuring the size of its army
- (C) counting its number of islands
- (D) wellbeing, sustainability, governance and culture, not money alone

31. Bhutan, a mountainous neighbour, produces much electricity from:

- (A) burning sea water
- (B) ocean tides only
- (C) imported coal alone
- (D) hydroelectricity (the force of flowing water)

32. Like Nepal, Bhutan is a _____ neighbour of India.

- (A) maritime
- (B) landlocked
- (C) island
- (D) coastal

33. Bhutan's choice to measure 'Gross National Happiness' suggests it values:

- (A) overall wellbeing and the environment alongside economic growth
- (B) only how rich it can become
- (C) only the size of its cities
- (D) only its military strength

34. Myanmar is described as India's:

- (A) nearest maritime neighbour
- (B) landlocked Himalayan neighbour
- (C) gateway to Southeast Asia
- (D) an island archipelago

35. Calling Myanmar a 'gateway to Southeast Asia' means it:

- (A) blocks all contact between India and Southeast Asia
- (B) is an island far out in the Pacific
- (C) links India by land toward the countries of Southeast Asia
- (D) has no border with India

36. Sri Lanka is India's:

- (A) largest land neighbour
- (B) only landlocked neighbour
- (C) farthest neighbour
- (D) nearest maritime neighbour

37. A 'strait', such as the one between India and Sri Lanka, is:

- (A) a tall mountain range
- (B) a narrow channel of sea connecting two larger bodies of water and often separating two lands
- (C) a chain of islands
- (D) a dry desert

38. The Maldives is described as a 'nation of islets', which makes it:

- (A) a landlocked country
- (B) an archipelago - a chain or group of many islands
- (C) a single large continent
- (D) a high mountain kingdom

39. An 'archipelago' is:

- (A) a country with no coastline
- (B) an extensive group or chain of islands
- (C) a single isolated mountain
- (D) a narrow channel of sea

40. Both Sri Lanka and the Maldives are connected to India mainly by:

- (A) the sea
- (B) a shared land border
- (C) the Himalayas
- (D) the Uttarapatha overland route

41. India and the Maldives cooperating closely shows that even small island neighbours:

- (A) matter for the security and friendship of the region
- (B) have nothing to offer their neighbours
- (C) can be safely ignored
- (D) are not real countries

42. The three great schools of Buddhism named in the chapter are:

- (A) Uttarapatha, Dakshinapatha and Silk
- (B) Kharif, Rabi and Zaid
- (C) Sovereign, Secular and Socialist
- (D) Theravada, Mahayana and Vajrayana

43. 'Theravada' Buddhism means:

- (A) 'the great vehicle' (B) 'the teaching of the elders'
- (C) 'the diamond vehicle' (D) 'the golden land'

44. 'Mahayana' Buddhism means:

- (A) 'the teaching of the elders' (B) 'the diamond vehicle'
- (C) 'the great vehicle' (D) 'the open border'

45. That Buddhism spread from India to many neighbours in three schools shows that India was:

- (A) a source of ideas and religion shared across the region
- (B) cut off from all its neighbours
- (C) a country that borrowed Buddhism from abroad
- (D) uninterested in its neighbours

46. 'Suvarnabhumi', an ancient Indian name for parts of Southeast Asia, means:

- (A) 'the thunder dragon' (B) 'the nation of islets'
- (C) 'the golden land' (D) 'the teaching of the elders'

47. Thai kings are named 'Rama' and the city 'Ayutthaya' echoes 'Ayodhya' because:

- (A) Indian culture and the Ramayana spread peacefully to Thailand
- (B) India once conquered and ruled Thailand
- (C) Thailand conquered India
- (D) the names are pure coincidence

48. The claim 'India became so influential in Thailand and Indonesia because it conquered them' is wrong because:

- (A) India did conquer them with large armies
- (B) Indian culture spread mostly through trade, travel and teachers, not armies
- (C) the cultures have no Indian links
- (D) the spread happened only in modern times

49. Thailand's 'Ramakien' is best described as:

- (A) Thailand's own version of the Ramayana
- (B) an exact copy of the Indian Ramayana with no changes
- (C) a Thai trade route
- (D) a school of Buddhism

50. The great Borobudur stupa, evidence of Indian cultural influence, is located in:

- (A) Indonesia (B) Sri Lanka
- (C) Bhutan (D) Afghanistan

51. Malaysia, Singapore and Indonesia are part of India's:

- (A) land neighbours sharing a border
- (B) landlocked Himalayan neighbours
- (C) Arctic neighbours
- (D) wider maritime neighbourhood across the seas

52. Iran and Oman are described as India's:

- (A) ancient western neighbours, linked by sea and old trade
- (B) eastern island neighbours (C) Himalayan land neighbours
- (D) Arctic neighbours

53. The 'Uttarapatha' and 'Dakshinapatha' were respectively the ancient:

- (A) northern and southern trade routes of India
- (B) two schools of Buddhism (C) two cropping seasons
- (D) two maritime neighbours

54. The Silk Route and the spice routes helped connect India to her neighbours by:

- (A) sealing India off from everyone
- (B) carrying goods, ideas and culture between regions
- (C) moving only soldiers, never goods (D) existing only in modern times

55. Ancient trade routes like the Uttarapatha and the spice routes best show that India's ties with neighbours are:

- (A) brand-new, formed only in the 21st century
- (B) purely military
- (C) very old, built up over many centuries
- (D) based only on conquest

56. 'SAARC' stands for the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, formed in:

- (A) 1947 (B) 1971
- (C) 2010 (D) 1985

57. SAARC was created to:

- (A) help one country conquer the others
- (B) promote cooperation among the nations of South Asia
- (C) end all trade in the region (D) replace every national government

58. A 'diaspora' is:

- (A) a narrow channel of sea (B) a chain of islands
- (C) a community of people who have spread out and settled far from their original homeland
- (D) a school of Buddhism

59. A 'bilateral' agreement is one:

- (A) among all the countries of the world
- (B) within a single country only
- (C) between a country and the sea (D) between two countries or sides

60. A student says, 'Sri Lanka isn't really a neighbour since we share no land border, and India must have conquered Thailand to spread its culture there.' The best correction is:

- (A) Sri Lanka is not a neighbour, and India did conquer Thailand
- (B) Sri Lanka is a close maritime neighbour, and Indian culture spread to Thailand peacefully through trade and religion, not conquest

(C) only land borders make neighbours, and culture spreads only by war

(D) India has no neighbours at all

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 14: India and Her Neighbours

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	D	11	A	21	D	31	D	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	A	22	C	32	B	42	D	52	A
3	D	13	B	23	C	33	A	43	B	53	A
4	B	14	C	24	D	34	C	44	C	54	B
5	C	15	B	25	B	35	C	45	A	55	C
6	D	16	A	26	B	36	D	46	C	56	D
7	D	17	C	27	D	37	B	47	A	57	B
8	C	18	B	28	A	38	B	48	B	58	C
9	C	19	D	29	C	39	B	49	A	59	D
10	C	20	A	30	D	40	A	50	A	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (D) A neighbour can be a land neighbour (shared border) or a maritime neighbour (shared sea). Language and currency are not what define a neighbour.

2. (A) A maritime neighbour is linked by a shared sea, needing no land border. A land-border country is a land neighbour, and landlocked or coastless describes the opposite.

3. (D) Sri Lanka and the Maldives, with no land border, are among India's closest neighbours via the sea. So not every neighbour shares land, India has maritime neighbours, and the sea does connect countries.

4. (B) Pakistan, Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh share land borders with India. The other lists include maritime neighbours like Sri Lanka, the Maldives, Indonesia, Thailand, Oman, Iran and Singapore.

5. (C) Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours, linked by sea. They are not land or landlocked neighbours, and they are certainly neighbours.

- 6. (D)** India sits at the centre of South Asia and the Indian Ocean. It is not at the heart of the Pacific, Atlantic, or Arctic regions.
- 7. (D)** The chapter gives India's land boundary as about 15,100 km. The other figures are far too small or too large.
- 8. (C)** The chapter gives India's coastline as about 11,100 km. The other figures are wrong.
- 9. (C)** A long coastline and central Indian Ocean position link India by sea to many maritime neighbours. India is not cut off, unable to trade by sea, or landlocked.
- 10. (C)** Regionalism is neighbours cooperating for peace, stability and progress. It is not war, mutual neglect, or merging into one nation.
- 11. (A)** Being neighbours means cooperating for the whole region's good. It is not wall-building, distant-only trade, or cultural separation.
- 12. (A)** Shared religion, trade and festivals bind the neighbourhood through deep cultural and historical ties. It is not disconnected, plane-only, or king-united.
- 13. (B)** The Himalayas separate India and China. The Indian Ocean, Thar Desert and Palk Strait separate India from other places.
- 14. (C)** China is a northern land neighbour across the Himalayas. It is not a Pacific maritime neighbour, an open-border partner like Nepal, or an island chain.
- 15. (B)** The Himalayas show geography shaping a border. Borders are not always coastal, mountains did not stop all trade (routes crossed them), and geography clearly affects neighbours.
- 16. (A)** India and Pakistan share heritage but have a divided history. Their pasts are not unrelated, their border is not the open Nepal-type, and they are land neighbours.
- 17. (C)** India and Pakistan share cultural roots but became separate nations - shared heritage, divided history. They are not unrelated, the same country, or unconnected.
- 18. (B)** Afghanistan is an ancient land-linked neighbour and friend. It is not maritime, an archipelago, or historically unconnected.
- 19. (D)** The Uttarapatha was the northern trade route from the Ganga plains to Central Asia through Afghanistan. It was not a southern sea route, a Buddhist school, or a peak.
- 20. (A)** The Uttarapatha through Afghanistan made it a key overland trade link for India. It was not cut off, sea-only, or an island.
- 21. (D)** Bangladesh is a relatively new nation, hence 'newborn neighbour'. It is not the world's oldest, ancient and unchanged, or a non-country.

- 22. (C)** A transboundary river crosses the borders of two or more countries (India and Bangladesh share several). It does not stay within one country, flow only underground, or flow uphill.
- 23. (C)** Shared transboundary rivers require cooperation on water management. The neighbours cannot simply ignore each other, halt all flow, or deny the rivers.
- 24. (D)** India and Nepal share an open border, crossable without a visa or passport. It is not sealed, maritime, or a gateless wall.
- 25. (B)** An open border still exists - people simply cross without a visa or passport, while both countries cooperate to keep it safe. Nepal is a separate country, and the border is not sealed.
- 26. (B)** Nepal is landlocked, nestled in the Himalayas. It is not an island, a coastal maritime neighbour, or a seaside desert.
- 27. (D)** A landlocked country has no coastline, ringed by land (like Nepal and Bhutan). It is not an island group, a long-coast country, or mid-ocean.
- 28. (A)** Even landlocked Nepal depends on the ocean for world trade, with goods passing through Indian ports - so India is its gateway to the sea. It does trade, has no coast of its own, and the sea is vital for trade.
- 29. (C)** Bhutan is the 'Land of the Thunder Dragon'. The 'Nation of Islets' is the Maldives, the 'golden land' is Suvarnabhumi, and Myanmar is the gateway to Southeast Asia.
- 30. (D)** Gross National Happiness measures wellbeing, sustainability, governance and culture, going beyond money. It is not money-only, army size, or island count.
- 31. (D)** Bhutan generates hydroelectricity from its flowing mountain water. It does not burn sea water, rely only on tides, or depend solely on imported coal.
- 32. (B)** Bhutan, like Nepal, is landlocked, with no coastline. It is not maritime, an island, or coastal.
- 33. (A)** Gross National Happiness shows Bhutan valuing wellbeing and the environment, not just wealth. It is not about riches alone, city size, or military strength.
- 34. (C)** Myanmar is India's land gateway to Southeast Asia. The nearest maritime neighbour is Sri Lanka; Myanmar is neither landlocked-Himalayan nor an archipelago.
- 35. (C)** As a gateway, Myanmar connects India by land toward Southeast Asia. It does not block contact, sit in the Pacific, or lack an Indian border.

- 36. (D)** Sri Lanka is India's nearest maritime neighbour, just across a narrow strait. It is not a land neighbour, landlocked, or the farthest.
- 37. (B)** A strait is a narrow sea channel between larger waters, often dividing two lands. A mountain range, island chain and desert are different features.
- 38. (B)** The Maldives is an archipelago of many small islands. It is not landlocked, a continent, or a mountain kingdom.
- 39. (B)** An archipelago is a large group or chain of islands (like the Maldives and Indonesia). A coastless country is landlocked, and the others are a mountain and a strait.
- 40. (A)** Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours connected by sea. They share no land border, no Himalayan link, and are not on the overland Uttarapatha.
- 41. (A)** Small island neighbours like the Maldives matter for regional security and friendship. They are not worthless, ignorable, or non-countries.
- 42. (D)** The three schools are Theravada, Mahayana and Vajrayana. The others name trade routes, cropping seasons, or Preamble words.
- 43. (B)** Theravada means 'the teaching of the elders'. 'Great vehicle' is Mahayana, 'diamond/thunderbolt vehicle' is Vajrayana, and 'golden land' is Suvarnabhumi.
- 44. (C)** Mahayana means 'the great vehicle'. 'Teaching of the elders' is Theravada, 'diamond/thunderbolt vehicle' is Vajrayana, and an open border is a Nepal-style border.
- 45. (A)** Buddhism spreading from India in three schools shows India as a source of shared ideas and religion. It was not cut off, a borrower of Buddhism, or uninterested in neighbours.
- 46. (C)** Suvarnabhumi (suvarna 'gold' + bhumi 'land') means 'the golden land'. The thunder dragon is Bhutan, the nation of islets the Maldives, and 'teaching of the elders' is Theravada.
- 47. (A)** Such names reflect the peaceful spread of Indian culture and the Ramayana to Thailand. India did not conquer Thailand, Thailand did not conquer India, and the echoes are not coincidence.
- 48. (B)** Indian scripts, religions and stories spread mainly through trade, travel and teachers, not conquest, and locals reshaped them. So it was not by armies, the links are real, and they are ancient.
- 49. (A)** The Ramakien is Thailand's own reshaped version of the Ramayana, showing local adaptation. It is not an unchanged copy, a trade route, or a Buddhist school.

50. (A) Borobudur, a vast Buddhist stupa, is in Indonesia and shows India's peaceful cultural influence. It is not in Sri Lanka, Bhutan, or Afghanistan.

51. (D) Malaysia, Singapore and Indonesia are maritime neighbours in the wider Southeast Asian neighbourhood. They are not land, landlocked-Himalayan, or Arctic neighbours.

52. (A) Iran and Oman are ancient western neighbours connected by sea and old trade. They are not eastern islands, Himalayan land neighbours, or Arctic.

53. (A) Uttarapatha (north) and Dakshinapatha (south) were ancient Indian trade routes. They are not Buddhist schools, cropping seasons, or neighbours.

54. (B) The Silk and spice routes carried goods, ideas and culture, linking India with its neighbours. They did not seal India off, carry only soldiers, or belong only to modern times.

55. (C) These ancient routes show India's neighbourly ties are centuries old. They are not brand-new, purely military, or conquest-based.

56. (D) SAARC was formed in 1985 to promote cooperation among South Asian nations. 1947 is India's independence, 1971 Bangladesh's birth, and 2010 is unrelated.

57. (B) SAARC promotes regional cooperation among South Asian nations. It is not for conquest, ending trade, or replacing governments.

58. (C) A diaspora (Greek diaspeirein, 'to scatter') is a community settled far from its homeland. A sea channel is a strait, an island chain is an archipelago, and Buddhist schools are Theravada, Mahayana and Vajrayana.

59. (D) Bilateral (Latin bi- 'two' + latus 'side') means between two countries. It is not global, single-country, or country-and-sea.

60. (B) Sri Lanka is a close maritime neighbour, and Indian culture reached Thailand peacefully via trade, travel and religion, not armies - correcting both errors. The other options repeat the misconceptions.